

THE LIFE ENERGY CENTERS

Greetings, my friends. Blessings in the form of love, strength, and understanding are coming forth to the degree you generate these within you. To that degree, you shall be able to perceive and accept the blessing that is streaming into you.

Tonight's lecture will be a beginning on the topic I started to discuss last time, that of the energy centers of the human structure. There is a great deal to say about this. We shall divide this topic into three fundamental aspects. The first aspect is going to deal with what determines the functioning of these energy centers. The second aspect will deal with the specific function of each center. In the last question-and-answer session, I have been asked about some of them, and I started, to a limited degree, to give a brief answer. So some of this second part will be a repetition for those who were present. And the third aspect will deal with the cultivation of these centers and practices with which the clogged up channels leading to them may be opened up. You must understand, my friends, that this very pathwork that you are engaged in, your self-confrontation, the development of your courage to look at yourself in truth (which is not half as easy as one believes before one starts) is already the most essential aspect of such a practice. For, any kind of practice that is mechanical -- that deals merely with exercises of concentration, breathing, etc. -- cannot possibly fulfill its purpose. So the basis is always to expand your consciousness, your vision, your perception of the truth of yourself -- therefore of your relationship to the universe and therefore of universal law and of creation. This will be borne out by what I have to explain about the first aspect to be discussed right now.

What determines the proper function of man's life force, hence of the energy centers, can only be understood if we gain a view of the entire structure of the human personality. For this, again, some recapitulation is necessary. The life force itself is the creative force that enlivens the whole universe. It contains all life elements and all potentials to manifest and express life in its myriad forms. This is such a powerful force that it must be made adaptable, it must be modified so as not to explode an organism whose consciousness is not yet sufficiently strong to accept this total power. Therefore each living organism possesses special centers which convert, assimilate, modify, balance the power that thus streams into the organism. The life force itself contains every possibility for life expression, for energy, health, bliss, modalities of self-expression. The centers of a human being are infinitely more differentiated and complicated than those, say, of a blade of grass. This is because the human being has proportionately more possibilities for varied self-expression than the blade of grass. The streaming into the organism of the life force must be "metabulated," distributed, and adjusted. Otherwise, the force would be too strong, as I said. If the human consciousness is divided and in conflict, if, on the one hand, it is sufficiently ready to "metabulate" more varied power, yet, on the other hand, it is imbalanced and disturbed, the centers close up. They become clogged. The process of self-realization also means the opening up of those centers.

It must be further understood that the human physical body is but a crude reflection of the real body, that is, his spiritual, eternal body. In the latter exist all functions and organs to an infinitely finer and more refined degree than can be found in the physical structure. This body of the eternal being cannot, of course, be seen with the human eye. But it is nevertheless much more real than anything that can be seen with the human eye. This body has several cruder outpicturings, according to the various levels of consciousness that exist when an entity is not yet unified with its spiritual self. The other subtle bodies reflect the various states of mind and personality levels of an individual. The physical level is but the crudest, most temporary outer manifestation, expressing the level of consciousness that is most alienated from its source -- the spirit being.

The centers exist in perfect form and functioning in the spirit body. There they are visible organs, as the heart or the kidneys are visible organs in the physical body. The various other states of consciousness, represented by specific subtle bodies, also contain these centers, but already altered in their functioning according to the degree of disunity with the spiritual structure. In the physical organism, those centers can be detected only indirectly. The glandular system reflects them, and their functioning is also determined by them. But the opening or closing of the centers, their smooth functioning or congestion, can be clearly experienced. The effect has distinct physical marks. However, the centers themselves are not visible for man.

Now, what determines the smooth functioning of those energy centers and therefore proper assimilation of the life force? It depends entirely and exclusively on the state of consciousness. Since consciousness is the origin of all that is, consciousness must also determine the most important system of life functioning. Every belief, opinion, concept, and idea determines man's feelings, reactions, attitudes, and expressions into life. It is inconceivable that an individual is unaffected by or indifferent to a deeply ingrained idea. And I do not merely mean conscious ideas and opinions. Even more important are the unconscious ones because they cannot be reoriented. An individual who is what we call self-realized -- whether still in his physical body or having already transcended the body state -- is in truth. He does not know everything, but he has an open mind. He is free from misconceptions. No false beliefs create fear, defensiveness, negativity, destructive emotions. Someone who is in truth about himself perceives the benign nature of the universe. He is open, joyful, without a trace of apprehension. Therefore he can expand in an harmonious way. In this light, unintense, undefended, relaxed state of body, mind, and feelings, the centers are open. They allow the life force to flow smoothly and freely, and the centers distribute the right kind of energy into the organism wherever specific aspects of the Great Force are needed. There is no clogging, no blocking, since there is no fear. And fear cannot exist if there is no negativity, no limitation of concept.

The more you develop and grow, the more aware you become how each mistaken idea creates destructive feelings, negativities, limited concepts of self and life. We spoke for a considerable time in our teachings here of the importance of the dualistic world view as opposed to a unified world view. A dualistic state of consciousness is one that perceives life always in terms of either/or, good or bad, this or that -- one to the exclusion of the other. The whole human sphere is indoctrinated with this error. This is difficult to understand for someone who has not yet entered deeply into his innermost being. He who has done so to a considerable degree and has therefore overcome some fundamental illusions about himself, some blocks in this respect, finds out how the universe expands for him in encompassing possibilities. Where he was convinced first to have to lose, to have to make unsatisfactory choices, by growing in integrity and objectivity, he eventually comes to a state

where he loses nothing. When the false, childish greed gives way, when the false, self-limiting sacrifice gives way, out of this duality fullness of experience arises.

The proper functioning of the life centers is not possible when the human being is still involved in the dualistic conflict. Perhaps the most basic dualism -- as discussed elsewhere in different contexts -- is the question of morality versus pleasure, of selfishness versus altruism, of self-deprivation versus depriving others. The whole concept of good and evil stems from this arbitrary, unnecessary, and mistaken concept of life. All human civilization, almost all philosophies, are poisoned by this basic split in the human consciousness. As long as you, my friends, believe that you have to make a choice between being good or obtaining your advantages, you must be in a terrible conflict. Only when you arrive at the realization, at the experience that depriving yourself must ultimately deprive others and, conversely, that by obtaining your real advantages (which may not be the shortsighted, childish ones, stemming from a limited, fearful outlook "this or nothing at all"), you ultimately also benefit others, you will be free from conflict. To reach this wider state of consciousness, it is necessary first to understand that your deeply ingrained conviction of limitation, of having to make decisions of self versus others, you will first experience just such situations in which it truly seems to be unavoidable to give up one for the sake of the other. For according to your belief, you must also experience. Your belief creates the condition. Thus false belief must be proven true until one begins to perceive of the relationship between belief and experience. If you accept that your inner, "invisible" belief creates this predicament of having to balance between your advantage versus those of others, you will have to deal with these self-created, limited conditions and will have to handle each instance separately with intelligence, with whole investment, with decency and integrity. No fearful sentimentality must blur your view to your rights. No childish greed must rationalize your self-centeredness. Both must be seen and overcome. Out of this, many decisions will be made, each different. Each loss will soon be discovered to be illusory. One time, you will forsake your own advantage because you see that what is on the scale does not warrant your wish for self-gratification. At other times, you will waive altruism because what is on the scale does not warrant your self-deprivation. More and more, you will be governed by true considerations, not by fear of disapproval, by dependency on other's good opinion, by fear of frustration and inability to stand nongratification. As this proceeds, you will soon have the vision that there is truly no division between your fulfillment and interests and those of others. In the long run, it all merges. The underlying truth conciliates both. But you cannot reach this state of consciousness cheaply. It requires your whole investment and involvement into each issue, no matter how apparently insignificant. In that way, dualism is transcended, and, consequently, fear, greed, a sense of deprivation, therefore anger, hostility, with all their derivatives. More and more, your consciousness perceives, experiences, and obtains the limitless abundance the universe has in store for all creatures. The first step must be knowing of its potential existence.

As long as you live in this basic human conflict, this split of consciousness, you must believe that you have to deprive yourself in order to be a decent, loving human being. Is it not natural that such a predicament induces feelings of resentment, frustration, anger, self-hate, guilt? And is it not natural that such feelings close up the psychic faculties, the streamings of healthy energy flow? When emotions are tightened up due to such negative feelings, the physical structure must eventually also tighten up. The tightness of the centers, in body and spirit, are always reflections of emotions of apprehension, anger, guilt, hate, fear.

This fundamental duality creates the chain reaction mentioned here: negative outlook, limited concept, conflict between self and others -- negative emotions -- hence limitation of experience. A state of consciousness must set in in which you subtly but definitely prohibit your own expansion. As you become more aware of yourself in the course of self-confrontation, you also begin to detect those subtle little reactions that indicate how you prevent yourself from expansion, from delightful experience. You detect how you are afraid of using the utmost of your potentials.

Any limited idea of your possibilities is a result of such a chain reaction. The real human sickness is the result of not using the full potentials to create good life, to create the best of circumstances. As you hold back your potentials to expand, to make better conditions, to experience deeper feelings of delight in every possible way, you continue a vicious circle. The result must be frustration, limitation, which is then assumed to be the nature of life -- at least as far as you are concerned. The deepening conviction increases the negative feelings, the tight defenses, the closed centers. As long as you feel obliged to make the tragic decision between goodness and joy, morality and pleasure, self-interest and love, you cannot ever fully decide, and you become so confused and disturbed that you react blindly and rigidly without quite knowing what governs you. The greatest "sin," if we want to use this word, is ignoring your potentials, is ignoring the possibilities for happiness, is setting yourself unnecessary fences beyond which you think you cannot go.

How does all this affect the specific centers? In order to understand that, we must first learn the meaning of each center and its particular function. Here I have to repeat some of what I said in the last question-and-answer session so as not to break the continuity.

The first center is the sexual center, located at the base of the spine. When I mention sexuality, I mean something that goes beyond limited genital pleasure. It comprises the whole extending of personal love to the opposite sex. It is the individual's capacity to experience pleasure on all levels -- the physical, the emotional, the mental, the spiritual -- without a trace of apprehension, tension, tight greed, separateness. It is the capacity to undefendedly give and receive. It is, most certainly, the ability to give yourself to the involuntary feeling processes without the ego need to be in control. It implies a trustful, accepting attitude toward one's own unconscious, with all its responses and movements. As you all know, this is most difficult for all human beings. But if it is attained, the sexual center will be open. It will not be clogged up by the ego need to be first in control. How can a person react without threat in this respect when his whole consciousness and perception of life is geared to limitation, deprivation, and therefore negative feelings, which he must fear to expose? Therefore the center must be closed, partially or completely. Hence, deprivation must be engendered because the full flow of the life force with all its regenerating, life bringing, health furthering, energetic faculties cannot be quite activated.

The second center is in the solar plexus. Its opening creates a connection with spiritual wisdom, with the consciousness of the universal being, and therefore it furthers general love feelings. For when you are in truth, you love. The opening of the sexual center enables the entity to the ever present, ever ongoing process of creation in regard to pleasure supreme, ecstasy. This contact is made in conjunction with a beloved other human being. The opening of the solar plexus channel makes connection with the ongoing, ever present, ever existing truth and goodness of ultimate reality. This ongoing real life can occasionally be detected, perceived, sensed. It usually happens when you really love and have thus transcended the dualistic struggle. Or it happens when

you discover, often even by dint of apparently insignificant events, your inner truth where you have hitherto not seen it. The spirit of such discovery is then accepting, not rejecting, of self and life. The perception of the ever ongoing life process in its infinite marvel of greatness, wisdom, love, and pleasure is an altogether different perception from the usual one, which is, "I must attain a new state." Such attainment would be impossible if it would not already exist on another level of reality. What you really have to do is discover this existence by first considering its possibility. Thus you must perceive of all states of bliss as existing already, all wisdom you ever need as existing already, all harmonious and balanced functioning, attitudes, and realization of your power and creative potentials as existing already, and your being separated from it by a wall. You must remove this wall. But the ongoing process of another life is already there. In your good moments, my friends, you are aware of this. You are aware that you have contacted another dimension of reality that is always there. In this dimension, there is utter peace and joy. There are all the answers, and there is life eternal, and there is nothing to fear. It is only when you are disconnected from this reality and begin to doubt or forget it, that you find yourself in real strife.

Anxietyless pleasure supreme is an ever existing reality in you already right now, and all that is separating you from it is your lack of knowing this, your fears and apprehensions, your own permission, as it were, to experience this reality. So it is true that the ever alive and appropriate wisdom, as you need it at any given instant of your life, is already there. You are merely separated from it by your not knowing it, by identifying with other sources of wisdom, which are, at best, a poor substitution. These may be your intellect, your unexplored emotions, which are merely reactive to attitudes whose nature you have not explored, other people's dicta over you, or all these mixed up together. Often you desist from establishing contact with this channel even when you have already experienced its immediate availability because you are afraid of the good feelings that result from its deep wisdom. You do not want to open up all these channels and centers and let yourself flow in unison with the universal cosmic movements. You are too afraid and too angry to do so. And this fear and anger must, first of all, be made conscious. Also, fear of disappointment and the lack of courage to be happy hold you back from expanding into that realm of reality where you find solutions for everything. In the solar plexus is the center that connects you with the supreme wisdom in relation to anything you ever need to know or ever could know. Such deep wisdom removes fear and makes love flow.

I want to interject here that the centers have some subdivisions or counterreflections. This is to avoid confusion. These might sometimes be interpreted as separate centers. For example, the center at the base of the spine has other projecting or concentration points, in the pelvis, in the genitalia. Or the center in the back has other concentration points, higher and lower in the back.

The next center is in the back. Its faculty is will. Now, so far, we can see that we have dealt with three basic human functions: feeling, knowing, willing. If harmony exists between these three functions, there is perfect interplay and no overweight on one at the expense of the other. The willing center is also the center of the ego, of aggression, of self-assertion, of backbone, of selfhood, self-responsibility, autonomy. All these attitudes are centered in and coming forth from the back. As indicated just before, there are two subdivisions -- one in the nape of the neck, the other further down, approximately between the shoulder blades. They both are reflections from one center which is located more "internally" in the spiritual body, perhaps somewhere in between. It manifests in the physical body primarily in these two places.

If the ego is not fully developed in its healthiest sense, this energy center is underactive. The energy does not flow smoothly through. By the same token, if the ego is overtight, stiff, anxious, too rigid, too self-willed, it implies another facet of the same predicament. Some personalities find it more expedient to dramatize the weakness and thus attempt to make an asset out of it. Others counteract the fear of their weak ego by overstressing pseudostrength. Both attitudes may result in similar problems manifesting in the body and mind. Tensions in the back distort the smooth flow and congest it.

Let us examine for a moment how the weak ego must influence the other functions of the two aforementioned centers: if you are weak and dependent you must be fearful. Hence, you must lack the courage for the great experience of living, for the deeper wisdom that transcends the ego. The weak ego makes you hold on so tightly that you cannot open up for what lies beyond its scope. It requires strength to trust, love, and be happy, to let involuntary processes do their part in the business of living. Perception of the greater reality of life must be hindered if the ego is not flexible and strong, independent without believing it is the only function to count on.

The next center is in the throat. This center symbolizes the capacity to take in, ingest and digest, assimilate and accept. A rigid individual whose inner unconscious problems create havoc must set himself against a flexible accepting attitude toward life, circumstances, unexpected developments, people, and his own unconscious inconsistencies and predictabilities. The weakness of the ego, the lack of independent self-responsibility, the weak back will have as its counterpart a rigid front that refuses to take in and swallow anything. He fears the possibility of being gullible because deep down he does not wish to stand on his own two feet. He fears his lack of backbone because he craves for approval more than for the integrity of being true to the self -- to truth, as it were. Hence, much of what life brings cannot be accepted and dealt with.

The next center is between the eyes. In Oriental philosophy, great stress is put particularly on this center. It is often called "the third eye." This center is a preliminary manifestation of total spiritual wholeness and fulfillment -- total realization of the divine self, which is expressed in the center at the top of the head. The center between the eyes is a vast capacity to visualize, to see, to comprehend. If the other, previously mentioned centers are open, are flowing, are harmonious, spiritual vision and perception comes about that gives an entirely new outlook on life, on the universe, on self, on everything that is. The opening of this center heralds the total integration expressed in the center in the top of the head. The latter combines all. When this occurs, one knows there is no limit, and all is one.

Of course, my friends, the opening of each center requires a great deal of work. It requires a total change of your consciousness, by which is meant, perhaps even more, your unconscious. Often your conscious being has the right knowledge, but is not sustained by your unconscious perceptions and reactions. So the work is long and concentrated. But it becomes joyful from a certain moment on, after the main resistances are overcome. And you can do so only by becoming fully aware of them. When these resistances then give way after a certain period, your expansion becomes mainly a joyful expression of living in itself.

One more word about the personality split of mankind, the dualism that wrecks a person's inner faculties to cope with anything -- this is for the purpose of helping you grow out of it so that your fears and defenses can begin to relax deep within you. The first step must be to become aware

of hitherto unconscious fears. This is, as you who work on this path well know, not as easy as it sounds. But once you are fully aware of them, you have to find a way to let go of the tightness this fear creates. This can only be done when you accept instead of resist. But what should you accept? -- deprivation, unfulfillment, sacrifice? Religion has taught this over the centuries and millennia out of its own misunderstanding. It is true that acceptance must take place, for as long as you say, "I must have this and must not experience the other," you are in a state of tight anxious defense. You are in an insurmountable struggle. This is perhaps the hardest lessons for the human state to transcend. How can you not adhere to "I must" without giving up on your happiness. This is so easily confused with negativity, resignation, and even masochistic self-denial. Religion's postulate that the good person must sacrifice is an error. The original meaning has two facets. (1) Sometimes selfishness must be overcome if what is at stake for the other is more important than what the self can gain. The feeling of love will often experience such acts as not at all depriving, but such love cannot develop in a climate of fear and coercion. (2) Even more important is the fact that here the attitude of letting go is emphasized. Every genuine spiritual visionary has tried to convey this to mankind. Only within the duality of the mind does letting go imply, "I must relinquish what I want." Beyond the duality, this is not so. If you can learn to let go, give up, if necessary, without relinquishing the realization of yourself, your fulfillment, you might indeed have to accept first that a specific manifestation of your desire cannot now be fulfilled as you have it in mind. This is the result of your own inner limited concepts and closed up energy centers that do not permit expansion. You still suffer from those results, and those results must be temporarily accepted (swallowed) without, however, losing out altogether. If you let go in a sense of fearful, resigned, obedient sacrificial deprivation, you remain in the duality. The untightening movement can only be temporary. But if you can let go in a spirit of trusting expectation, your necessary momentary loss will soon turn out to be a gain. You make room for new and different possibilities of experience if you do not insist on a limited form right now. If you learn to let go in that way, you transcend duality. You come out of the struggle to deal with fear and deprivation, on the one hand, versus tight holding on with guilt and anxiety, on the other. If you can let go in the trusting spirit, "If it cannot be had this way, then perhaps another way; if not now, later," you will lose fear, tightness of centers, sense of loss. Then the life forces will bubble and surge through your entire system, through the entire organism -- the physical, the mental, the emotional, and the spiritual. They will work in full harmony, functioning in the way life is destined, which is utter bliss and forever greater expansion. Then the energy centers will function in harmony and will dispose of the waste energy that is now held within your system. There can be no greater toxic psychic poisoning than undisposed waste material of energy that should leave the system. You know this holds true about everything else -- food, water, air. So the identical principle must apply to the "metabulation" of energy and of mind material. All that functions as it should must be constantly renewed, disposed of, and gone on from there to gathering new material.

Try to digest some of what I have said here. Study these words, make use of them, go with them, make them your own. Let it be an incentive that life can be so very different from what it is. What you experience now at its best is only a small token of what still lies in store for you. And the difficulties you experience are a kind of disease, as it were, and unnecessary -- something that can certainly be eliminated if you learn to properly understand their meaning. And that is, of course, the most important thing. For, the majority of human beings experience their difficulties as if they came to them by accident. "This is life" prevents the connection of the consciousness to see the difficulty as a vital expression of the self no matter how much it seems to be inflicted upon the self from the outside. It is never so. And to the degree you can understand your life experience as an expression

of that part of yourself you are not familiar with yet, you will truly overcome the obstruction to your happiness. You all need help to do this. The victory, the liberation, the surge of joy and peace that comes from that is incomparable. No good that comes to you from the outside because others happen to act according to your will could ever be as peace giving and joy bringing as the realization and understanding of your difficulties. That is indeed the transcendence and evolution of your personal being. Then the joy will expand forevermore, and life will become more and more as it is meant to be, as it already is, as a potential existing in this other dimension from which you are still separated in your consciousness.

Be blessed, all my dear ones here. The love of the universe, the love that is here, encompasses and envelops all of you wherever you may be.

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